Markup languages in general are a family of programming languages, all of which use annotations or tags to wrap content (intended for human consumption) in order to assign machine-readable meaning to that content. The other markup language we'll look at in this section is XML (eXtensible Markup Language), which is very similar to HTML but differs in one crucial aspect: XML allows you to define any tags you like, but HTML uses predefined tags (you can't just make new ones up). Most HTML tags are used in opening/closing pairs to form *elements*. Elements can contain text for display and other elements to form a tree structure. Other elements do not require a closing tag because they are not intended to contain text or other elements (and are said to be "self-closing"). For example:

```
<a href="...">I am a hyperlink</a>
<img src="..." />
```

Above are two HTML elements represented as `<a></a>` (anchor) and `<img />` (image) tags. All of the text between the opening and closing chevron characters is treated as metadata for that element, and these are known as *attributes*. In the example above, the anchor tag has an `href` attribute, and the `<img>` tag has a `src` attribute.

Anchors are the fundamental "currency" of HTML; these form the links in documents that you can click on (when using a web browser) to go elsewhere. The text content inside the `<a></a>` tags is the part that is rendered by the client, usually with some visual cues to show that it is a link. The `href` attribute of `<a>` tags tells the client where to go if the link is followed; for example, `<a href="https://www.yahoo.com">...` would take the user to `https://www.yahoo.com` if clicked.

Images are, of course, the pretty pictures that make your content engaging. Note the closing meta-characters of the image tag – `/>` – this is the "self-closing" syntax I mentioned (images don't contain any other text or HTML content, so they don't require the closing-tag syntax). Image tags have `src` attributes, which tell the client where to load the image from, which can be from the same site or another one entirely. `<img src="/images/cat.jpg"` is a *relative URL*, which would attempt to load the image from the current domain, starting at the root. If you want to load a resource relative to the current resource path, omit the leading slash: `<img src="images/cat.jpg"` would append to the current resource path, `../images/cat.jpg` would attempt to load from one level up from the current path. Exactly like a filepath in fact. If the request to fetch the image resource results in a valid image file response it would then be rendered in place in the document.